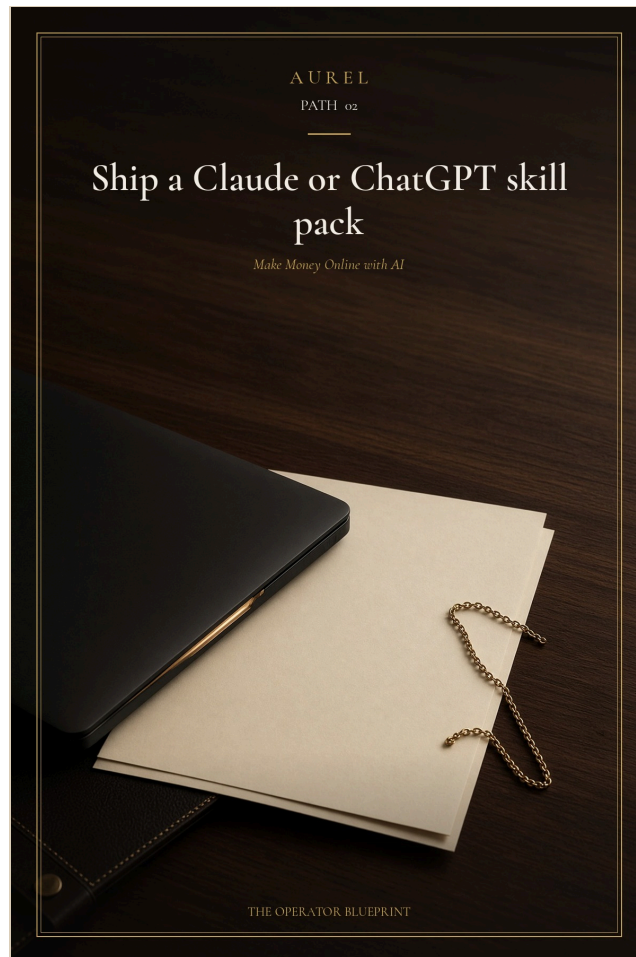


THE OPERATOR SUITE · PATH 02



PATH 02

Ship a Claude or ChatGPT skill pack

They already pay the model. They are paying you to stop starting from zero.

18 minute read · 4,000 words

Who this is for

People who use Claude, ChatGPT, or Gemini every week and keep rebuilding the same chat.

Time to first

3–10 days

Tools

First sale

One \$19 order from someone who used the model this week.

Cash window

\$19–\$39

Leave this alone

Claude Projects or Custom GPTs, a zip of the skill files, a one-page install, Stripe.

A 200-prompt dump with no job in the title. Competing with free GitHub lists on volume.

What this actually is

A small appliance, not a prompt PDF

A skill pack is a working stack: instructions the model follows, examples of good output, and a way to install it in under ten minutes. It is not a PDF of prompts. It is closer to a small appliance. Plug it in, get the job.

The buyer has already decided AI is useful. Their pain is the blank window. Your job is to replace that window with a named job: weekly content, invoice follow-up, meeting notes into tasks, a listing description, a study plan.

The title is the product

If they cannot tell from the title what file they get and what job it does, they will not buy. "Claude Power Pack" is a mood. "Client follow-up skill for solo bookkeepers" is a product.

A skill pack ships as files they can paste or upload: a system-instructions file, one sample input, one sample output, and a one-page install. If you only send a list of prompts, you shipped a weaker version of Niche prompt stacks. This path is the installable version of a job.

What you are not selling

You are not selling access to a model. They already pay Anthropic or OpenAI. You are not selling 200 clever lines. You are selling the first message being raw material — an overdue invoice list, a messy email thread — and the model already knowing the format, the tone, and when to stop and ask.

Who this is for — and who should skip it

This fits you if

You use Claude, ChatGPT, or Gemini every week and keep rebuilding the same chat. You have a job you have run in a window more than twice. You can write instructions as if you will never be in the room: role, inputs, output format, quality checks, what to ask if information is missing.

You do not need to be a developer. You need to have finished the job in a chat and been annoyed that you had to re-explain it the next time.

Skip this path if

Skip if you have never run the job in a model yourself. Skip if you want to compete with free GitHub lists on volume. Skip if your title would be "200 ChatGPT prompts." That market is noise, and this path loses when you play it.

If you need cash this week and you do not already live in these tools, write a playbook or take a service job first. A skill pack is fast only if the job is already in your fingers.

The buyer on the other side

The buyer is not a prompt tourist. They already have a Plus or Pro tab open. They are a bookkeeper, a recruiter, a clinic manager, a realtor who pastes the same messy input every Friday and rewrites the instructions from memory. They will pay \$19 to never start from zero again.

The offer, named in one sentence

Fill this first

"I help [specific person] finish [named job] in [named tool] in under [time], even if they are not a prompt person." If you cannot name the tool and the job, you do not have a skill pack. You have a vibe.

Examples that work: a solo bookkeeper who needs client follow-up emails from an invoice list in Claude; a recruiter who needs a scored shortlist from a pile of messy resumes; a tradesperson

who needs a job-to-Google-post in one paste.

What they get, said plainly

They get a zip: system instructions (or a Custom GPT / Claude Project recipe), a sample input, a sample output, and a one-page install they can follow on a tired night. They do not get a course. They do not get a community. They get the appliance.

Price the job, not the file count

First skill packs sell at \$19. \$29-\$39 is fair when the install is clean, the sample is real, and you include a 20-second screen recording of blank chat versus the skill. Do not bundle 40 jobs to justify \$49. One job, done, at \$19, outsells a suitcase of half jobs.

What "done" looks like

The install test

Done means a person who did not write it can install it in under ten minutes and get a usable first output from the sample. If they need you on a call, it is not a skill pack yet. It is a service.

Write the install as clicks: where to open, what to paste, what to send first, how they know it worked. If a step is "set up your workspace," you hid the work.

The quality test

Run the skill on a real example. Save that output as the sample in the zip. Then run it on a broken example — missing amount, missing date, rude client note — and confirm it asks once and stops instead of guessing. Silent guessing is how people lose trust.

The sales test

Checkout title is the job. Price is \$19. You have bought it from a second email. The zip opens. The install PDF is one page. You have asked five people who already use Claude or ChatGPT. Done is not a catalog page with six other ideas.

Pricing that holds

\$19 is the default

One \$19 order from someone who used the model this week is the first sale that matters. \$19 matches "I already pay for Claude; this saves me the blank window." It is low enough to try tonight and high enough that you will answer a support email.

Do not price at \$9. You will attract collectors who never install it, and you will hate the one-star "too simple" review from someone who wanted 200 prompts.

When \$29-\$39 is honest

Raise when you have: a 20-second screen, a real sample, failure modes in the instructions, and at least one stranger who installed it without you. That is a better product, not a different mood. Stay under \$39 until you have a version history and a second related skill you can bundle.

What you never do

Do not promise it works on every model. Build for one: Claude Projects, Custom GPTs, or Gemini Gems. Say which one on the listing. If a buyer uses the other, refund and point them at the install they would need — or do not sell it to them. Do not add a \$97 "with a setup call" on day one unless you mean to run Productized AI service instead.

The first 72 hours

Pick the job and write the room

Pick one job you have done in a chat more than twice. Open a new project. Write the system instructions as if you will never be in the room: role, inputs they must paste, output format, quality checks, what to ask if information is missing.

Paste this to get a first draft of the instructions, then rewrite every line in your voice:

Write system instructions for [tool] that a tired [person] will use. Job: [job]. The user's first message is only the raw material: [what they paste]. You will return [format]. If [critical field] is missing, ask once, then stop. Do not invent numbers. Include three quality checks you run before you show the draft.

Run it, package it, film it

Run it on a real example. Save the output as the sample. Write a one-page install: where to click, what to paste, how to test. Zip it. Price \$19. Record a 20-second screen: blank chat versus the skill.

Put the video and the checkout in one place. Ask five people who already use Claude or ChatGPT. Do not explain the catalog of other ideas you have.

The 72-hour list

- One job, written as system instructions

- One real example output in the zip

- One-page install a tired person can follow

- Twenty-second screen recording

- Five asks, not fifty features

The path, step by step

Steps 1-4: watch, write, fail, version

Step 1. Watch how the buyer actually works. If they live in email, do not build a Notion skill. If they live in Claude on a phone, the install cannot assume a desktop sidebar they have never opened. Sit with one real run of the job.

Step 2. Write the skill so the first message from the user is just the raw material. The skill should not need a prompt engineer on their side. If they have to write a paragraph of instructions after they install it, you failed.

Step 3. Add failure modes: "If the invoice amount is missing, ask once, then stop." Silent guessing is how people lose trust. List the three fields you will never invent. Put that list in the instructions, not in a blog post about your process.

Step 4. Version the file. v1 is allowed to be narrow. You will ship v1.1 after the first buyer. Put "v1.0" in the README and the filename. When you fix install wording, bump it. Buyers should know they can re-download.

Steps 5-8: package, title, prove, sell

Step 5. Package: README, skill or instructions file, sample input, sample output. That is enough. The README is the one-page install, not a manifesto. Filename the zip after the job: bookkeeper-client-followup-claude-v1.zip.

Step 6. Checkout title is the job. Thumbnail is the screen recording still. Description names the tool, the install time, and the sample. "Works in Claude Projects. Ten-minute install. Sample invoice list included."

Step 7. Record the 20-second screen. Left: blank chat, slow. Right or after: paste the raw list, get the follow-ups. No music. No intro. The last two seconds are the \$19 line and the link.

Step 8. Sell where those users already complain: X threads, Reddit help posts, Discord. Help first. Link in profile. Do not dump the zip in a comment. Dump the result of the job, then let the profile hold the buy link.

Steps 9-12: ask, support, patch, stop

Step 9. Five personal asks to people who already use the model. "I built a [job] skill for [person]. \$19, ten-minute install. If you want it: [link]. If not, ignore."

Step 10. After purchase, a three-line email: install, test with the sample, reply if it breaks. That reply is your product roadmap.

Step 11. Fix whatever the first buyer could not install. Ship v1.1. Same checkout, new zip. Email the people who already bought.

Step 12. Do not add a second skill until this one has a stranger sale. One appliance that works beats a store of toys.

A worked example

Marcus, solo bookkeepers, \$19

Marcus is a solo bookkeeper. Every Friday he writes the same follow-up emails: invoice sent, invoice 7 days late, invoice 21 days late, polite close-the-loop. He used to paste a messy spreadsheet into Claude and spend twenty minutes restating the tone. He ships a Claude skill: "Client follow-up for solo bookkeepers." Price: \$19.

His one sentence: "I help solo bookkeepers turn an invoice list into send-ready follow-up emails in Claude in one paste, even if they are not a prompt person."

What is in the zip

SKILL.txt — system instructions: you are writing follow-ups for a solo bookkeeper. Inputs: client name, invoice number, amount, days late, last contact. Output: subject line plus a short email in the bookkeeper's voice (plain, not cute). Never invent an amount or a date. If amount or days late is missing, ask once, then stop. Three tones: reminder, firm, final. Default to reminder unless days late is over 14.

SAMPLE-INPUT.txt — eight fake invoices, names blurred from a real week, amounts intact in spirit.

SAMPLE-OUTPUT.txt — the eight emails the skill produced, which Marcus actually sent after a human pass.

INSTALL.pdf — one page: open Claude, new Project, paste SKILL.txt into instructions, drop SAMPLE-INPUT as the first message, compare to SAMPLE-OUTPUT, then paste your own list.

He recorded 20 seconds: blank chat ("write follow-ups for these invoices") versus the Project with the skill. Same list, two very different first drafts.

How he sold it

He asked five people: two other bookkeepers in a Slack, his old firm colleague, a freelancer Discord, and a person who had tweeted "Claude keeps making up invoice amounts." He did not pitch a catalog. Two of the five bought. A stranger bought on day 6 after he replied to that tweet with the result (amounts correct, tone plain) and left the link in his profile.

The first buyer could not find "Project instructions" on mobile. Marcus added two screenshots to INSTALL.pdf, bumped to v1.1, and emailed both buyers. He did not start a second skill for tax organizers. Not yet.

Copy you can actually send

DM

I built a [job] skill for [person] who already uses Claude. Ten-minute install, \$19. If that is useful: [link]. If not, no need to reply.

Post

I wasted two hours prompting this. The skill does it in one paste. \$19.

Or, with the screen still:

Blank chat vs the follow-up skill. Same invoice list. Left one invented an amount. Right one asked. \$19, install in 10 minutes. Built for solo bookkeepers. Not a prompt dump.

Listing

Title: Client follow-up skill for solo bookkeepers — install in 10 minutes.

Body:

What you get: Claude Project instructions, a sample invoice list, a sample of the emails, and a one-page install.

What you do: paste your list. Get send-ready follow-ups. It will not invent amounts.

What you need: Claude (Projects). Not a prompt engineer.

Price: \$19. Instant zip. Email me if it breaks.

Email after purchase

Subject: install, then test with the sample

Open the INSTALL page. Ten minutes.

Run SAMPLE-INPUT first. Match it against SAMPLE-OUTPUT so you know it loaded.

Then paste your own list. If it breaks, reply to this with a screenshot. I will fix the file.

Reply to an objection

"Can't I just save a prompt?"

You can. A skill pack is the instructions plus failure modes plus a sample so you know it loaded. If your saved prompt already asks for missing amounts and never invents them, you do not need this. If you rewrite the instructions every Friday, \$19 is cheaper than another Friday.

"Does it work in ChatGPT?"

This one is built for Claude Projects. I will not pretend it is the same in a Custom GPT. If you only use ChatGPT, do not buy this version. Refund if you already did.

Week-by-week if you have a job

Days 1-2: write and test

One job you already run. Write the instructions. Run a real example. Run a broken example. Save both. You can do this in two evenings after work. Do not design a landing page yet.

Day 3: package and checkout

README, skill file, sample in, sample out. Zip. \$19 Payment Link or Stan. Buy it from a second email. Record the 20-second screen on your phone if you have to.

Days 4-7: five asks, one post a day

Five personal messages. Post the screen recording once a day in one place — same clip, same offer. Help in two threads where people complain about the job. Link stays in the profile.

Week 2: patch, then wait

Fix whatever the first buyer could not install. Ship v1.1. Do not add a second skill until this one has a stranger sale. If nobody bought, the title or the tool is wrong. Ask one of the five: "Would you even install this?" Then change the title, not the whole stack.

Quality bar

Instructions that survive you leaving the room

Role in one line. Inputs named. Output format named. Three quality checks. A stop rule for missing facts. No "be helpful" filler. No claim that it replaces a bookkeeper, a lawyer, or a clinician. It drafts. They send.

The sample is real enough to trust

Blur names. Keep the ugly: a client who pays late every time, a line with a missing PO, a note in all caps. If the sample is a perfect table, the skill will look smart and fail on Friday.

Install a tired person can finish

One page. Numbered clicks. One screenshot if a menu is hidden. A line that says "you will know it worked when the sample output looks like this." If they have to watch a 12-minute video, you wrote a course. Cut it.

Metrics that matter (and vanity numbers to ignore)

Count these

Installs that produce a first output from the sample (ask: "Did the sample run?")

Stranger sales at \$19

"It broke" emails — these are the roadmap

Time-to-install reports. If two people say it took 30 minutes, the one-pager failed

Refunds because of the wrong model. That is a listing problem. Fix the title.

Ignore these

Stars on a prompt marketplace. How many skills you listed. GitHub-style star counts. Views on the screen recording if nobody clicks the checkout. Lines of instructions. "Community" member counts you do not have yet.

One line a week

Date, asks sent, sales, break-emails, version number. If v1.0 never becomes v1.1, you are not talking to buyers.

Objections you will hear

"I already have a Custom GPT / a Project."

Good. This is a better set of instructions plus a sample so they can test it. If theirs already does the job, they should not buy. If they keep tweaking it every week, \$19 is the freeze-frame that works.

"Skills are going to be free from the labs."

Some will be. Generic ones. A client-follow-up skill that knows a solo bookkeeper's tone and will not invent an amount is not on the default home screen. You are selling the job, not the concept of a skill.

"I am not technical."

Neither is the buyer, if you wrote the install. If you cannot write the install without the word "repo," this path will hurt. Use Claude Projects or Custom GPTs, not a local install.

"What if the model changes and it breaks?"

You version the file. You date the README: "Tested on Claude, [month year]." You email v1.1 to people who bought. That is the job after the first sale. It is also why you do not sell 40 jobs in one zip — you cannot maintain them.

"Can you just set it up for me?"

Yes, as a service, for a different price. This path is the zip. If you want setup-for-hire, that is Custom project setups or Productized AI service. Do not throw a call into a \$19 product.

How this feeds other paths

Same job, other shapes

The instructions inside the skill are a Niche prompt stack if someone wants to paste instead of install. The sequence you used to build it is Sell an AI playbook. The checklist in the README is an AI template. Let the first buyers tell you which shape they asked for.

Where it gets sold

AI-assisted short-form: the 20-second blank-vs-skill clip is the whole path. A weekly AI letter: one failure mode explained, link to the zip. Your front door: a diagnostic ("do you rewrite the same Claude chat every Friday?") then the skill.

When it becomes a service or a membership

Local businesses + AI: install the same skill for a nearby owner and charge a setup fee. Custom project setups and Automation setups are the grown-up version for people who want it connected to their inbox. A small AI membership is how you send v1.2, v1.3 as the model changes — after the \$19 file has strangers using it.

Do not open a membership to avoid shipping v1.

Mistakes that kill this path

The listed ones

Shipping prompts without install steps. Promising it works on every model. Bundling 40 jobs so none of them are good. Using other people's copyrighted prompt packs as your file.

The quieter ones

A title with no job. A sample that is too clean. Instructions that guess at missing money or medical facts. A 14-page install. A video instead of a one-pager. Asking fifty people for feature ideas before five people have installed v1. Naming it after yourself instead of the job.

The trust ones

Invented numbers. Invented legal language. A "medical" or "legal" skill that claims it is compliant. This path drafts operational writing. It does not practice. Put that limit in the instructions and on the listing.

Tools and how you actually use them

Where the skill lives

Claude Projects: paste the instructions into the project. Custom GPTs: paste into the GPT builder instructions. Gemini Gems: same idea, different menu. Pick one for v1. Write the install for that one only.

You are not shipping an API app. You are shipping text files a human pastes. If you need Zapier, you wandered into Automation setups.

The zip and the page

Folder: README (the install), SKILL or INSTRUCTIONS, SAMPLE-INPUT, SAMPLE-OUTPUT. Zip it. Stripe Payment Link or Stan delivers the zip. That is the stack from the original tools line. Do not add a course platform.

The 20-second screen

Phone screen record is enough. Desktop is cleaner if the buyer is on desktop. Show the blank chat failing or stalling, then the skill succeeding on the same paste. No intro bumper. The still from second 3 is the thumbnail.

Ship checklist

Before you zip

- One job in the title

- Instructions: role, inputs, output format, quality checks, stop rules

- Will not invent named fields (amounts, dates, diagnoses)

- Real sample input and sample output

- Broken-example test: it asked, then stopped

- One-page install with the actual clicks

- Version number on the README

Before you ask anyone

- Zip opens on a phone

- Checkout title = the job; price \$19

- Self-purchase from a second email

- 20-second screen recorded

- Five names who already use the model

- After-purchase three-line email written

After the first install

- Fix the install trip-up

- Ship v1.1 to people who bought

No second skill until a stranger sale

FAQ

Is this just a prompt pack?

No. A prompt pack is paste-as-you-go. A skill pack is installed once so the first message can be the raw material. If they want 25 separate prompts for a clinic week, that is Niche prompt stacks. If they want follow-up to live in Claude, that is this.

Claude, ChatGPT, or Gemini?

Pick the one you actually use for this job. Write for that one. Saying "works everywhere" is how you get refunds.

Do I need to code?

No. You need to write instructions and a one-page install. If you are building an API wrapper, you left this path.

What if Anthropic or OpenAI ships this exact skill?

Then you sell the version that knows this job's tone and failure modes, or you move to the playbook and the service. Generic will always be free later. Specific stays yours if the sample is real.

How many skills should I launch with?

One. Five asks. One stranger sale. Then a second skill only if they ask for the next job.

Can I put it on a GPT store or a skill directory?

After it works at \$19 on your own checkout. Directories are extra. They are not the first 72 hours.

What do I do when a buyer says it "sounds like AI"?

The instructions need their voice. Add three sample sentences they actually send. Marcus put two real follow-ups he had already mailed (names changed) into SKILL.txt under "match this tone." That killed the peppy bot voice.

Is \$19 too low if it saves a Friday every week?

It is the right first price. Raise to \$29-\$39 after a stranger has installed it and you have the screen and the failure modes. Do not start at \$79 with no proof.

What if they want it connected to Gmail?

That is Automation setups or Custom project setups, priced as a project. Do not promise inbox connection inside a \$19 zip.

Can I use someone else's skill as a base?

No. Do not use other people's copyrighted prompt packs as your file. Write the instructions from the job you actually do. The scar tissue is the product.